



FLIES

You have probably seen a housefly zooming around your kitchen. Most people think of flies as pests—annoying little creatures that

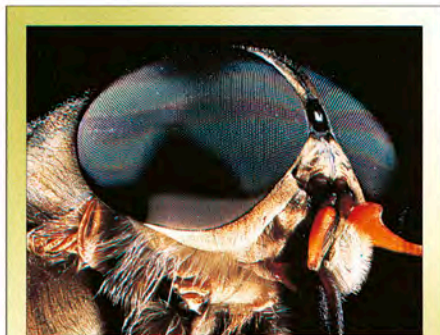
buzz around us, bite us, walk on our food, and spread disease. But in other ways, flies are a necessary and useful part of our world. They help to pollinate plants and are a source of food for a variety of other animals.



A hoverfly taking off

Sensitive flies

Flies have surprisingly strong senses. This means they have very good eyesight, and a keen sense of taste and smell.



Nice to see you!

Our eyes have just one rounded lens. A housefly has thousands of six-sided lenses. Each lens sees a part of a bigger picture. This creates an image of colored dots, like a pixelated picture from a digital camera.



Flies have two large compound eyes which see colors and shapes.

Many flies, like the housefly, have small antennae.

When the fly finds liquid food, it simply sucks it up. If it finds solid food, the fly first dissolves it with special juices.

At the end of a fly's mouth are two pads that look like lips.

